Mahatma Gandhi's 'Do or Die' speech. The rest is history. The 'Quit India' title found echoes in millions of hearts. People translated the phrase into their own languages. In Marathi it transformed into '*Chale jaav*'—get lost. The popular Hindi version was '*Chhodo Bharat*'—leave India. The intent was the same, the determination was equally strong, whether in Tamil, Assamiya or Gujarati. Everyone knew 'enough was enough'.

'*Chhodo Bharat*' quite rhymes with '*Jodo Bharat*', but it is not just the rhyme or the rhythm that makes the two so akin. There are far more important reasons for looking at '*Jodo Bharat*' as '*Chhodo Bharat 2*'. As the movement unfolds with its immense possibilities, the slogan may eventually get translated into many languages and may become 'Connect India' in English, '*Samparkisalu Bharata*' in Kannada, '*Inaikka Natu*' in Tamil, '*Desh Jodishu*' in Gujarati and many other varieties in many other languages. Despite the diversity, the spirit of the movement will be the same—that the union of states that is India will survive only if diversities are respected, that we are one because we are many. '*Jodo Bharat*' is, therefore, a movement to remind people that we are a nation because we are founded upon the Constitution that defines us as a union of states—geographically as well as 'mental states', people with many different cultural practices, theological affiliations and linguistic identities. In simple words, the objective of the Innaika Natu or Desh Jodishu movement was to connect the people back with the Constitution, to bridge the emotional divide between the idea of the republic and the people, whose minds had been bombarded with divisive sentiment.

The Jodo Bharat movement, like Chhodo Bharat, was about all Indians—not just city dwellers, not just taxpayers, not just productive agers, not just voters. It was about all Indians regardless of their age, gender, caste, religion and economic status. It was also about the India that had been and the India that people wanted to see in future as a civilized nation—a vibrant democracy and a federation of states based on mutual respect. In its highest horizon of expectations, it was about the idea of India held high by Indians since civilization sprang in South Asia several millennia ago.